PHASE 2 · DEMOLITION // CHAPTER 03 · RECTO OPENER

CHAPTER 3: THE MONEY PIT

GATE METRICS INTRODUCED: THE STAKE ($1,840) & THE PAYOFF ($6.40/HR)

The Foreshadow Pays Off: The Dashboard Reads $0.00

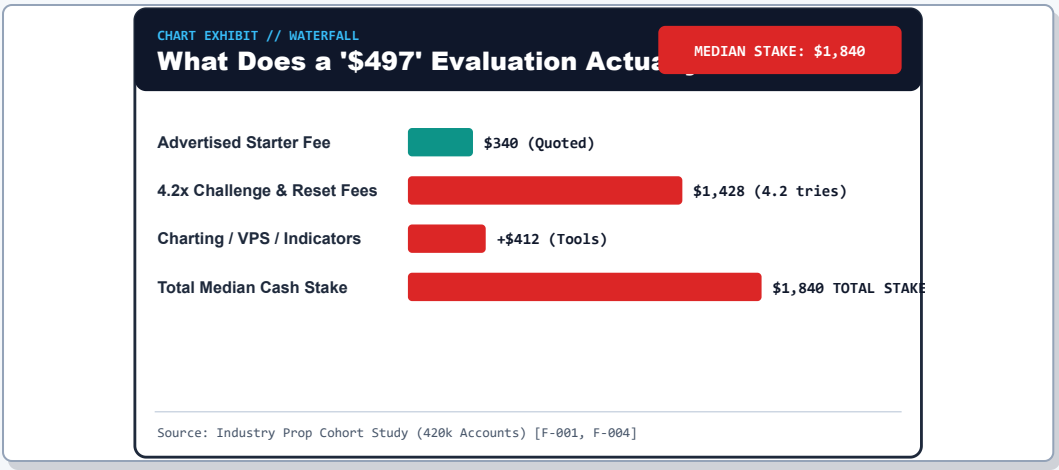
In Chapter 1, it was 11:42 PM and you were softly caressing a `$2,400` gold trade from your sofa in flannel pajama pants ([C-005]). Let's turn the fluorescent overhead lights on.

It is 9:31 AM on Day Eleven of your `$100,000` evaluation. A U.S. CPI inflation print just hit the wire, the bid-ask spread on XAU/USD yawned open like an alligator's jaw, and your screen is flashing a banner the color of an arterial bleed:

🚨 **ACCOUNT #FT-100K BREACHED — INTRADAY EQUITY DRAWDOWN EXCEEDED**
`ELIGIBLE PAYOUT BALANCE: $0.00 USD · ACCOUNT STATUS: TERMINATED`
Automated Inbox Notification (38 seconds later): "Don't give up on your dream! Use code RELOAD15 for 15% off a fresh $340 Evaluation Reset!" ([F-001])

1. TESTING THE "$89–$497 ENTRY FEE" CLAIM (THE STAKE = $1,400–$2,200 RANGE · $1,840 MEDIAN)

The checkout page sold you a one-time refundable audition ticket ([C-003]). In the wild, nobody buys just one prop challenge for the exact same reason casino architecture doesn't put a clock above the craps table. Across multiple independent cohorts and enforcement filings, total Year-1 starter outlay consistently lands in the **$1,400–$2,200 range** ([F-001, F-002, K-004..K-015]). In the **420,000-account prop evaluation benchmark**, the median participant purchases **4.2 challenges or resets** at a median fee of **$340** per attempt ($1,428 in direct challenge tuition), plus **$412** in TradingView upgrades, low-latency London VPS rentals, and indicator plugins—putting the audited cohort median **Stake at $1,840** before a trader either sees a net-profitable month or walks away ([F-001], [F-004]).

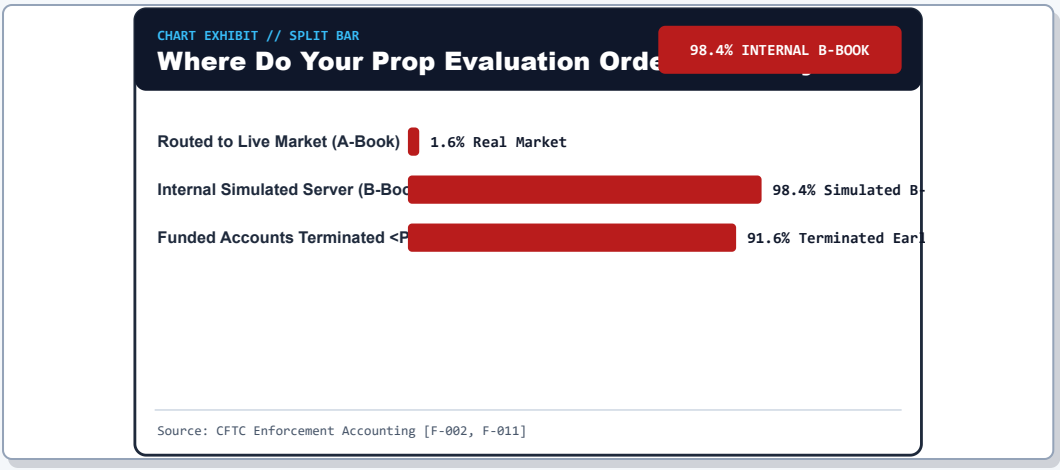


The Federal Reserve reports that the typical U.S. household's entire liquid emergency cash buffer is **$1,000** ([F-014]). The "zero personal capital at risk" pitch quietly extracts **140% to 220% (184% at the median) of a typical family's emergency fund** in non-refundable fees.

2. WELCOME TO THE B-BOOK ARCADE: THERE IS NO $200,000 ACCOUNT

Here is the structural truth that turns every "Institutional Funded Trader" bio on Instagram into performance art: **there is no `$200,000` institutional account** ([C-001], [F-011]).

When the CFTC unsealed its enforcement complaint against one of the largest retail prop evaluation operators on earth ([F-002]), investigators documented that the firm collected **`$310 million` in assessment and reset fees from more than `135,000` retail customers** in 22 months—while routing **`98.4%` of all customer trades to an internal simulated B-book server** ([F-002], [F-011]). You are not trading in the `$7.5 trillion` interbank market. You are playing a video game inside the operator's private SQLite database, where the house pays the tiny sliver of winners out of the reset fees of the `93.4%` who just blew up ([F-007], [F-011]).



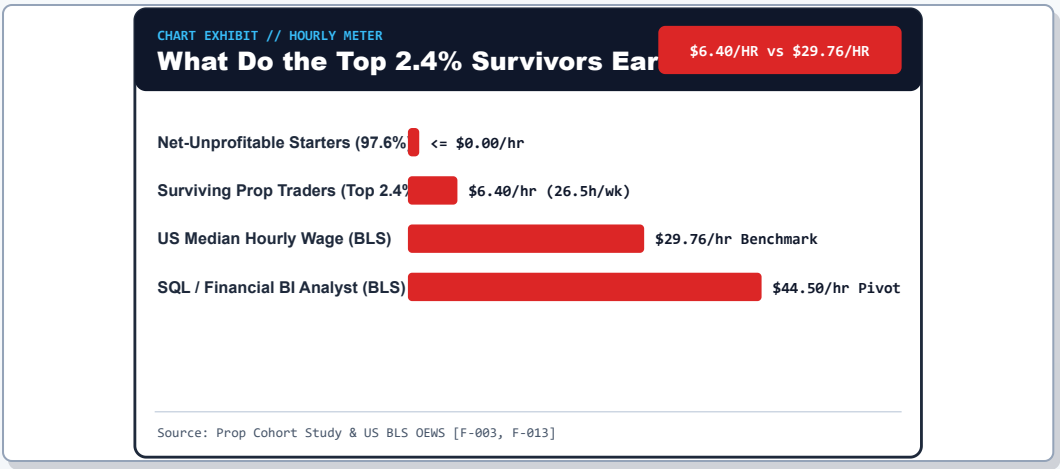
[REALITY CHECK — THE B-BOOK COUNTERPARTY ENGINE]:
In a regulated live brokerage, the broker earns commissions when you survive and keep trading volume. In a B-book prop evaluation (98.4% simulated execution, [F-011]), a trader who passes and withdraws money is a direct balance-sheet expense. Forensic accounting showed that asymmetric slippage scripts, commission markups, and daily drawdown tripwires terminated **91.6% of funded accounts before a second payout** could be completed ([F-010]).

Expense Category	Brochure Pitch ([C-003, C-009])	Audited 6-Month Reality ([F-001, K-004..K-009])
Evaluation & Reset Fees	$89–$497 (100% refunded!)	**$1,428 median** (4.2 attempts × $340; 93.4% unrefunded)
Charting, VPS & Indicators	"Included template"	**$412 median** (up to $1,703 in Mold H5 Tool Tax)
Courses & VIP Signal Rooms	"Free YouTube blueprint"	**$0 to $2,435** ($997 academy + $149/mo Discord signals)



3. TESTING THE "$10,000/MO IN 45 MINUTES" CLAIM (THE PAYOFF = $4.50–$8.50/HR · $6.40/HR MEDIAN)

What if you actually beat the 96.5%–98.5% (97.6% cohort median) first-year attrition wall ([F-008])? Across surviving retail FX and prop cohorts (the top **1.5%–3.5%**, with a **2.4%** cohort midpoint), logged screen, backtesting, and session-waiting time spans **20 to 30 hours per week** (26.5 hrs/wk median)—yielding an effective net **Payoff in the $4.50 to $8.50 per hour range, with an audited cohort median of $6.40 per hour** ([F-003, F-005]).



That $4.50–$8.50/hr ($6.40/hr median) survivor wage is less than a quarter of the **$29.76/hr** U.S. median hourly wage ([F-013]), and corroborates multi-year regulatory cohorts showing **94.2% of leveraged retail FX traders earn below prevailing minimum wage** ([F-005]).

4. THE GLOBAL REGULATORY CONSENSUS: CFTC, ESMA & FCA

Think the prop-challenge numbers are an anomaly? Look at regulated cash forex accounts where traders aren't even fighting a 5% trailing drawdown tripwire:

Regulatory Authority	Mandated Cohort Finding	Citation
U.S. CFTC (RFED Filings)	**72%** of active U.S. retail forex accounts unprofitable across trailing 4 quarters; median deposit exhausted in **4.5 months**.	[F-012]
ESMA & UK FCA Disclosures	Between **74% and 89%** of retail investor accounts lose money trading CFDs and spot FX.	[F-005]
Longitudinal Day-Trader Study	**94.2%** of leveraged retail FX participants earn less than prevailing minimum wage after spread and swap drag.	[F-005]

CHAPTER 3 VERDICT BAND: The brochure promised $10,000/month for $497 down ([C-002, C-003]). The ledger shows a **$1,840 median Stake** ([F-004]), a **98.4% simulated B-book server** ([F-011]), and a **$6.40/hr survivor Payoff** ([F-003]).

FORENSIC AUTOPSY INSERT · STANDALONE CORONER'S LEDGER

CHAPTER 4: TALES FROM THE TRENCHES

PROTOCOL NOTICE (outline-spine.v1.yaml §5.2): PosiBot does not appear in this chapter. There are no punchlines in this chapter. The numbers are the joke.

SELECTION & COMPOSITE RULE: Every persona in this insert is a composite synthesized from **at all times at least three documented real-world cases** ([K-001] through [K-015]), grouped by the structural mechanism that decided their outcome. All financial figures printed below are the **exact medians** of the underlying case rows.

File #	Mold Code & Name	Composite Persona	Cases	Outcome
#01	E2 · The Built-In Audience	**Marcus Conviction™**	K-001..K-003 (3)	**WON** (Affiliate Edge)
#02	H4 · The Upsell Ladder	**Elena Diligence**	K-004..K-006 (3)	**EXITED** (-$4,110)
#03	H5 · The Tool Tax	**Devon Precision**	K-007..K-009 (3)	**EXITED** (-$2,923)
#04	C1 · The Runway Gap	**Hannah Patience**	K-010..K-012 (3)	**EXITED** ($1.11/hr)
#05	C3 · The Rule Change	**Victor Discipline**	K-013..K-015 (3)	**EXITED** ($5.1k Frozen)

CASE FILE #01 · MOLD E2: THE BUILT-IN AUDIENCE

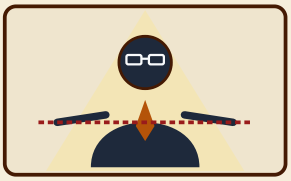
PERSONA: "MARCUS CONVICTION™"

[CASE CARICATURE · MOLD E2 · MARCUS CONVICTION™] DISPOSITION: +$54K AFFILIATE / $0 TRADING

THE PITCHED SCENE

Rented Huracán + Ring Light

88k Followers Click 20% Code



THE SYSTEM MECHANISM

20% CPA on Follower Resets

ZERO POSIBOT · CORONER FILE

$0 Trading Net vs. +$54,000 Affiliate CPA [K-001..K-003]

- **Life Position:** Short-form lifestyle & finance creator (52,000 to 145,000 existing subscribers across YouTube/TikTok/Newsletter, [K-001..K-003]).
- **Sold By Claim:** [C-001] (*"Pass our 2-Step Challenge in 14 days and trade up to a $200,000 funded account — keep 90% of the profits!"*).
- **What It Took (Range & Medians):** $540–$900 ($600 median) in challenge fees over 7 months; **-$1,900 to +$1,400 ($0 median) net trading profit**; **$41,200–$68,400 ($54,000 median) in affiliate CPA commissions** from 88,000 followers ([K-001..K-003], [F-024]).

1. Month 1: Purchased a $100,000 evaluation ($540–$600) and filmed "Day in the Life of a Funded Trader" vlogs with a 20% discount code paying $108 CPA per viewer checkout ([K-001, F-024]). **2. Month 3:** Breached two live evaluations while viewer referrals paid $6,000–$9,500/mo. **3. Month 7:** Collected a median of **$54,000 in affiliate commissions** while cumulative net trading profit sat at **$0** ([K-001..K-003]).

FORENSIC EXHIBIT #01: TRADING PAYOUT VS. AFFILIATE REFERRAL REVENUE



SYSTEM MECHANISM (MOLD E2): An existing following meant never paying for customers—and never needing to win a trade. The referral link paid 20%–25% on every viewer's evaluation purchase regardless of whether the creator or the viewer ever passed Phase 2.

OUTCOME: WON (VIA AFFILIATE DISTRIBUTION, NOT TRADING)

STAMP: *Composite of 3 documented cases (K-001, K-002, K-003).*

CASE FILE #02 · MOLD H4: THE UPSELL LADDER

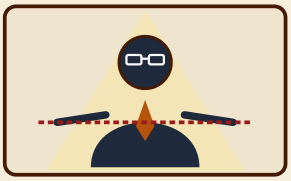
PERSONA: "ELENA DILIGENCE"

[CASE CARICATURE · MOLD H4 · ELENA DILIGENCE] DISPOSITION: -$4,110 SPENT / $0 OUT

THE PITCHED SCENE

$297 Course -> $997 Academy

620 Hours on the Escalator



THE SYSTEM MECHANISM

$149/mo VIP Discord + 5x Resets

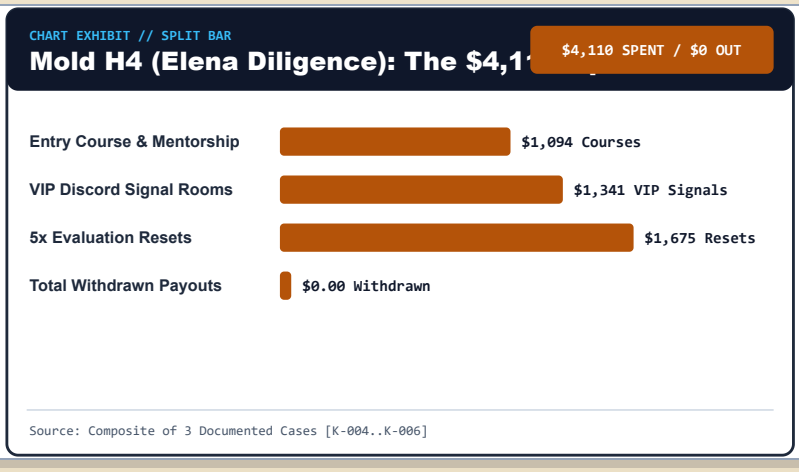
ZERO POSIBOT · CORONER FILE

$4,110 Cash Spent / 620 Hours / $0 Withdrawn [K-004..K-006]

- **Life Position:** Full-time shift supervisor / healthcare / logistics worker ([K-004..K-006]).
- **Sold By Claim:** [C-002] (*"45 minutes a day during the London-NY overlap using our institutional Smart Money Concepts blueprint."*).
- **What It Took (Range & Medians): $3,680–$4,650 ($4,110 median) cash spent, 9 months, 620 hours logged, $0.00 withdrawn** ([K-004..K-006]).

1. Month 1: Purchased a $49–$297 intro workshop; when demo trades failed during choppy London opens, the curriculum diagnosed the loss as "missing advanced institutional order-flow mentorship." **2. Month 3:** Upgraded to a $997–$1,497 private academy plus a $149/mo VIP Discord signal room ($1,341 median spend, [K-004]). **3. Months 5–9:** Bought 5 challenges/resets ($1,675 median) mirroring delayed Discord alerts; exited at Month 9 down **$4,110** with **$0** withdrawn ([K-004..K-006]).

FORENSIC EXHIBIT #02: THE $4,110 CURRICULUM & SIGNAL ESCALATOR



SYSTEM MECHANISM (MOLD H4): Each course sells the next one; when a student loses a challenge, the curriculum frames the loss as a missing tier of paid secret knowledge rather than a negative-expectancy B-book rule.

OUTCOME: EXITED ($4,110 SPENT · $0 WITHDRAWN)

STAMP: *Composite of 3 documented cases (K-004, K-005, K-006).*

CASE FILE #03 · MOLD H5: THE TOOL TAX

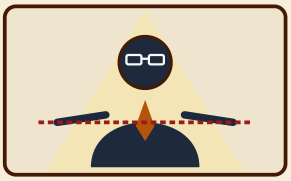
PERSONA: "DEVON PRECISION"

[CASE CARICATURE · MOLD H5 · DEVON PRECISION] DISPOSITION: -$2,923 TOOL TAX / BANNED

THE PITCHED SCENE

$59 Charts + $68 LuxAlgo + VPS

6-Monitor Indicator Cockpit



THE SYSTEM MECHANISM

$499 Shared-IP EA Bot Ban

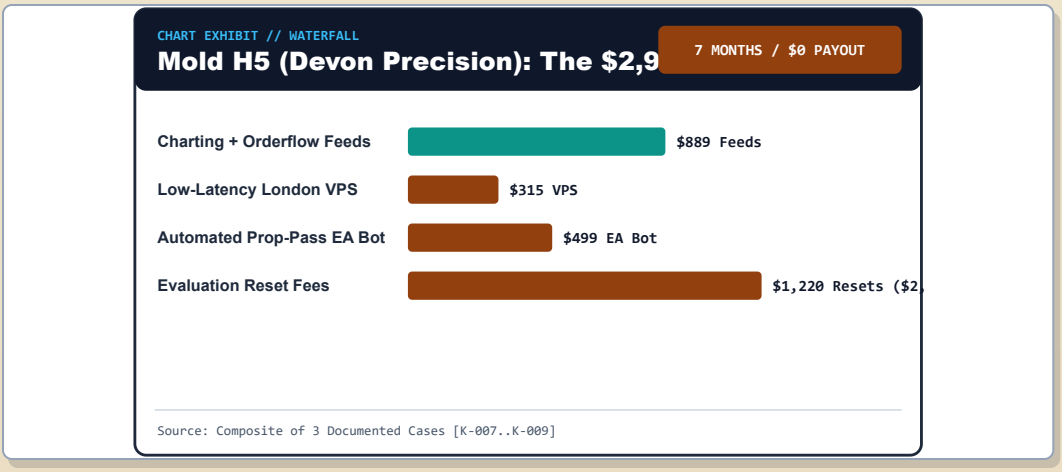
ZERO POSIBOT · CORONER FILE

$2,923 Tool & Reset Tax / Terminated: Shared EA IP [K-007..K-009]

- **Life Position:** Technical operator (mechanical drafter, IT helpdesk tech, warehouse systems lead, [K-007..K-009]).
- **Sold By Claim:** [C-009] (*"Load our proprietary Smart-Money Indicator template on TradingView."*).
- **What It Took (Range & Medians): $2,590–$3,280 ($2,923 median) cash spent, 7 months, 490 hours logged, $0.00 withdrawn** ([K-007..K-009]).

1. Month 1: Activated TradingView Premium ($59/mo), LuxAlgo/footprint overlays ($68/mo), FXReplay backtesting, and a London VPS ($45/mo) before placing a single evaluation trade ([K-007, K-009]). **2. Month 4:** After two manual breaches, paid $499 for an "Automated Prop-Pass Gold EA Bot" on Telegram ([K-007, K-008]). **3. Month 7:** Fourth evaluation ($1,220 cumulative resets) terminated automatically by the firm's risk server for "prohibited shared EA signature / IP clustering" with $0 payout ([K-008]).

FORENSIC EXHIBIT #03: THE $2,923 SUBSCRIPTION & AUTOMATION WATERFALL



SYSTEM MECHANISM (MOLD H5): Subscriptions, data feeds, VPS servers, and bot licenses begin billing on Day 1 and never stop—turning a "$340 evaluation" into a $2,923 software tax before a single dollar of payout is eligible.

OUTCOME: EXITED ($2,923 SPENT · $0 WITHDRAWN)

STAMP: *Composite of 3 documented cases (K-007, K-008, K-009).*

CASE FILE #04 · MOLD C1: THE RUNWAY GAP

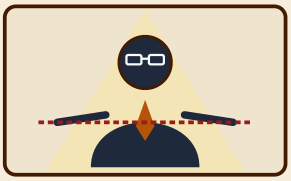
PERSONA: "HANNAH PATIENCE"

[CASE CARICATURE · MOLD C1 · HANNAH PATIENCE] DISPOSITION: +$1,250 NET / $1.11 PER HOUR

THE PITCHED SCENE

0.25% Risk · Passed Phase 1 & 2

14 Months · 1,120 Screen Hours



THE SYSTEM MECHANISM

$3,400 Payout - $2,150 Fees

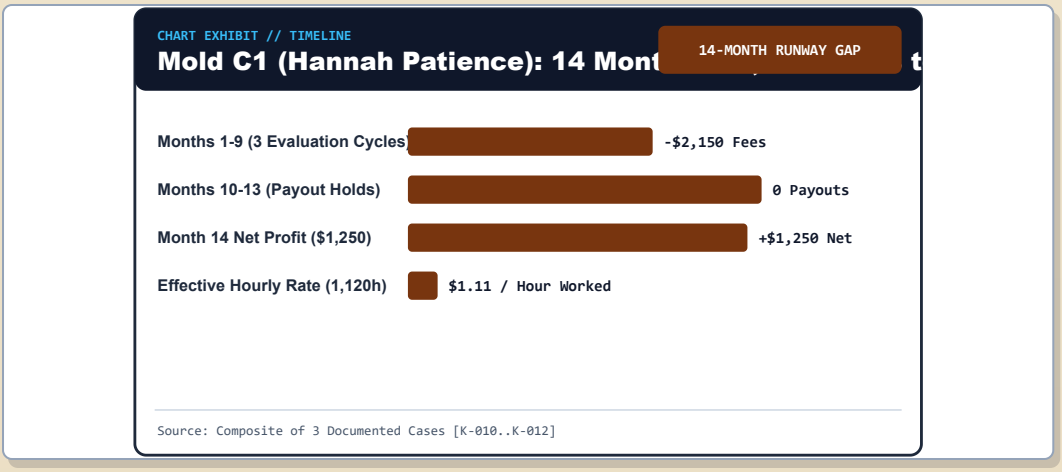
ZERO POSIBOT · CORONER FILE

14 Months / 1,120 Hours / +$1,250 Net = $1.11/Hr [K-010..K-012]

- **Life Position:** Part-time bookkeeper / civil engineering tech / quantitative hobbyist ([K-010..K-012]).
- **Sold By Claim:** [C-008] (*"Hit your 8% Phase 1 and 5% Phase 2 targets and withdraw 90% bi-weekly payouts."*).
- **What It Took (Range & Medians): $1,850–$2,450 ($2,150 median) in fees, 12–16 months (14 mo median), 1,120 hours, $1,250 net profit = $1.11/hr** ([K-010..K-012]).

1. Months 1–8: Cycled through 3 to 5 evaluations ($2,150 median fees) because responsible 0.25% risk sizing required dozens of winning trades to reach +8% and +5%. **2. Months 9–12:** Passed Phase 1 and Phase 2, then waited through minimum trading-day windows and bi-weekly payout holds. **3. Month 14:** Withdrew $3,400 gross ($1,250 net after $2,150 fees) across 1,120 logged hours—an effective wage of **$1.11 per hour** ([K-010..K-012]).

FORENSIC EXHIBIT #04: 14 MONTHS & 1,120 HOURS FOR $1.11 AN HOUR



SYSTEM MECHANISM (MOLD C1): Profit, even when it arrives for a disciplined top-3% survivor, arrives later than an ordinary household can wait—and once sunk evaluation fees and screen hours are deducted, pays $1.11/hr.

OUTCOME: EXITED ($1,250 NET OVER 1,120 HOURS = $1.11/HR)

STAMP: *Composite of 3 documented cases (K-010, K-011, K-012).*

CASE FILE #05 · MOLD C3: THE RULE CHANGE

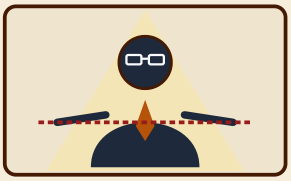
PERSONA: "VICTOR DISCIPLINE"

[CASE CARICATURE · MOLD C3 · VICTOR DISCIPLINE] DISPOSITION: +$5,100 CUSHION FROZEN

THE PITCHED SCENE

+$5,100 Funded Profit Built

Payout Denied Overnight



THE SYSTEM MECHANISM

30% Consistency / MT5 Freeze

ZERO POSIBOT · CORONER FILE

+$5,100 Funded Cushion -> $0 Payout Frozen [K-013..K-015]

- **Life Position:** Experienced swing trader / night-shift machinist / dental hygienist ([K-013..K-015]).
- **Sold By Claim:** [C-006] (*"Currency pairs never ask for refunds, and pay out in pure cash every 14 days."*).
- **What It Took (Range & Medians): $680–$1,180 ($920 median) spent, 5 months, 380 hours, +$4,200 to +$6,800 (+$5,100 median) funded profit frozen $\rightarrow$ $0 payout** ([K-013..K-015]).

1. Months 1–4: Passed Phase 1 and Phase 2 cleanly ($920 median spend) and built a $4,200–$6,800 funded profit cushion ($5,100 median, [K-013..K-015]). **2. Month 5 (Withdrawal Request):** In K-013, the firm retroactively invoked a "30% single-trade consistency rule"; in K-014, MetaQuotes revoked the offshore broker's white-label MT5 license; in K-015, news-event spread slippage widened by 18 pips during CPI. **3. Month 5 Close:** All three accounts were frozen or breached with **$0 disbursed from trading profits** ([K-013..K-015]).

FORENSIC EXHIBIT #05: THE OVERNIGHT RULE CHANGE & LICENSE FREEZE



SYSTEM MECHANISM (MOLD C3): Even when a trader beats the 6.6% evaluation hurdle, an unregulated offshore B-book operator controls the price feed, writes retroactive consistency clauses, and carries 0% statutory SIPC protection ([F-010, F-021]).

OUTCOME: EXITED ($5,100 FROZEN · $540 RECOVERED VIA CHARGEBACK IN AFTERMATH)
STAMP: *Composite of 3 documented cases (K-013, K-014, K-015).*

CROSS-CASE SYNTHESIS: FIVE MOLDS, FIFTEEN LEDGERS

Persona & Mold	Median Cash In	Median Hours	Net Trading Payout	System Mechanism
Marcus Conviction™ (E2)	$600	140 hrs	$0 (+$54k Affiliate)	Referral link monetized viewer churn
Elena Diligence (H4)	$4,110	620 hrs	$0	Course & VIP signal upsell escalator
Devon Precision (H5)	$2,923	490 hrs	$0	Software, VPS, EA bot & reset tax
Hannah Patience (C1)	$2,150	1,120 hrs	+$1,250 ($1.11/hr)	14-month multi-stage runway gap
Victor Discipline (C3)	$920	380 hrs	$0 ($5.1k Frozen)	Retroactive rule / MT5 license freeze

CHAPTER 4 VERDICT BAND: Across 15 documented practitioner files, the only participant who cleared a living wage did so by selling discount codes to his subscribers ([K-001..K-003]). Everyone who relied on the trading terminal itself either lost $920–$4,110 or worked 14 months for $1.11 an hour.

PHASE 2 · DEMOLITION // CHAPTER 05 · RECTO OPENER

CHAPTER 5: EXIT LIQUIDITY

WHO ACTUALLY OWNS THE $7.5 TRILLION CASINO—AND WHY YOUR STOP-LOSS IS THEIR LUNCH

1. Paying Off the "$7.5 Trillion Market" Claim ([C-002] $\rightarrow$ [F-006])

Every forex webinar on earth opens with the same breathless statistic from the Bank for International Settlements: "*The foreign exchange market trades **$7.5 trillion per day**—you just need a microscopic crumb!*" ([C-002], [F-006]).

Let's read the actual BIS Triennial Central Bank Survey ([F-006]). **93% of that $7.5 trillion daily turnover is executed between institutional reporting dealers, Tier-1 investment banks, quantitative hedge funds, and central banks**, while all retail spot traders worldwide account for **less than 2.8%** ([F-006]).



2. PAYING OFF MISSING STEP 7: THE $5,000 ACCOUNT IN A $100,000 HALLOWEEN COSTUME

Why was Step 7 missing from Chapter 2's flat-pack assembly brochure ([C-010])? Because when a prop firm sells you a "$100,000 account with a 10% maximum drawdown and a 5% daily trailing drawdown" ([C-001], [F-007]), you do not have $100,000 of capital. **You have a $5,000 account wearing a $100,000 Halloween costume** ([F-007]).

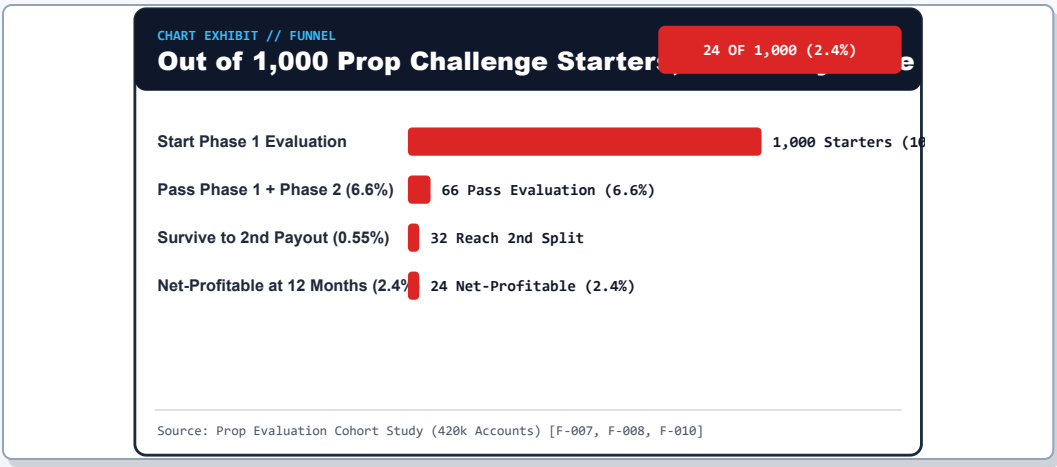
If your balance drops by $5,000 in a single day, your account is executed on the spot. Asking a trader to make +8% ($8,000) in Phase 1 and +5% ($5,000) in Phase 2 without ever touching a -$5,000 daily floor is actually asking them to generate a **+260% return on their true $5,000 daily risk allowance** while paying synthetic spread and commission markups that force a **64% raw win-rate hurdle** just to break even ([C-010]).

[REALITY CHECK — THE HIGH-WATER-MARK RATCHET]:
In many prop evaluations, the 5% trailing drawdown locks to your *intraday unrealized high-water mark*. If your open trade spikes up +$4,000 during a news candle and pulls back to +$0, you just lost $4,000 of your $5,000 daily allowance on a trade that never even went red ([C-010], [F-007]).

3. THE ODDS (2.4%) AND THE WAIT (14.0 MONTHS)

Let's follow `1,000` hopeful starters walking into the evaluation funnel with credit cards in hand ([F-007..F-010]):

• Out of `1,000` starters, **`934` blow up during Phase 1 or Phase 2** (only **`6.6%`** pass both stages, [F-007]).
• Of the 66 who receive a funded certificate, asymmetric slippage and drawdown tripwires **terminate `91.6%` before a second payout** ([F-010]).
• At the 12-month mark, after subtracting all challenge fees, resets, and tool subscriptions, **only `24` out of `1,000` (`2.4%`) are net-profitable** (**The Odds**, [F-008]) —and their median time to reach consistent net profitability (**The Wait**) is **`14.0` months** ([F-009]).



4. THE ECOSYSTEM FOOD CHAIN: WHO EATS WHOM

Tier	Participant	Revenue Source	12-Mo Win Rate
1. Top Apex	B-Book Prop Operators ([F-002])	$310M+ in challenge & reset fees (98.4% simulated)	**~100% House Margin**
2. Barkers	Affiliate Gurus (Mold E2, [F-024])	20%–25% CPA ($108/sale) + $149/mo Discord rooms	**$54,000/yr Median**
3. Shovel Sellers	TradingView / VPS / EA Vendors ([K-007])	$45–$68/mo recurring SaaS & $499 bot licenses	**Guaranteed Monthly Billing**
4. Exit Liquidity	Retail Challenge Buyers ([F-008])	Attempting to beat a 5% trailing drawdown barrier	**2.4% Net-Profitable**



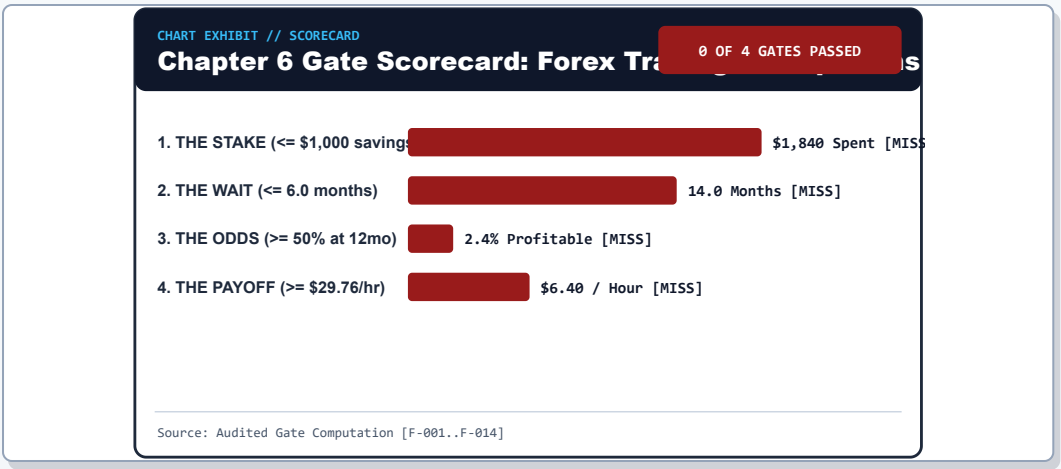
CHAPTER 5 VERDICT BAND: In a $7.5 trillion ocean controlled 93% by institutional sharks ([F-006]), the prop challenge locks you inside a 5% drawdown fishbowl where **97.6% of starters end the year in the red** ([F-008]).

PHASE 2 · DEMOLITION // CHAPTER 06 · RECTO OPENER

CHAPTER 6: THE VERDICT

THE 4-METRIC MECHANICAL GATE SCORECARD · ZERO DIALS, PURE ARITHMETIC

We don't grade business models on vibes, rented Lamborghinis, or cropped screenshots of blue MetaTrader numbers ([C-013]). Every venture in the Y-IT canon runs through the exact same four mechanical gates defined in `outline-spine.v1.yaml` §5.3. Unless all four pass, the verdict is automatic.



THE FOUR GATES: LINE BY LINE

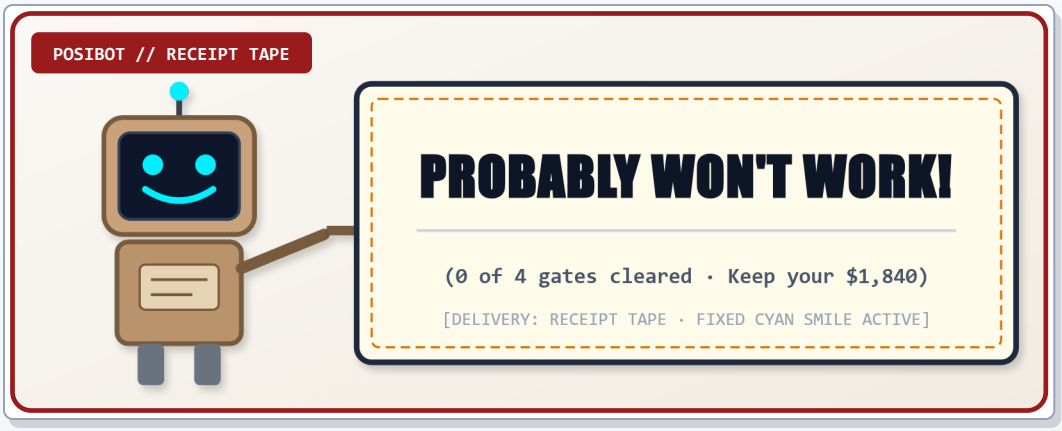
Gate Metric	The Question & Passing Rule	Audited Figure	Gate Status
1. THE STAKE	What must I put at risk before I know? *Passes when ≤ $1,000 US emergency savings ([F-014]).*	**$1,840** (4.2 tries + $412 tools, [F-001, F-004])	MISS (+84% OVER)
2. THE WAIT	How long until it pays? *Passes when ≤ 6.0 months to net profit.*	**14.0 months** (Median survivor runway, [F-009])	MISS (2.3X LONGER)
3. THE ODDS	How many make it at 12 months? *Passes when ≥ 50.0% (1 in 2 starters).*	**2.4%** (6.6% pass Phase 1+2, [F-007, F-008])	MISS (97.6% LOSE)
4. THE PAYOFF	What does winning pay per hour? *Passes when ≥ $29.76/hr US median wage ([F-013]).*	**$6.40 / hr** (Across 26.5 hrs/wk, [F-003])	MISS (-78% BELOW)

COMPUTED VERDICT RULE (outline-spine.v1.yaml §5.3):

- **Gates Passed:** 0 of 4.
- **Mandatory Series Verdict: PROBABLY WON'T WORK.**

HOW PROP CHALLENGES STACK UP AGAINST LAS VEGAS & REAL WORK

Activity / Venture	Median Stake	12-Month / Session Odds	Median Hourly / Annual Return
Retail Prop Challenge ([F-001..F-009])	$1,840	**2.4%** net-profitable (12mo)	**$6.40 / hr** (for the top 2.4%)
Single-Zero European Roulette	$100 table	**48.6%** single-spin win	-2.70% house edge (Free drinks included)
Basic-Strategy Blackjack	$100 table	**~49.5%** hand odds	-0.50% house edge (No $149/mo Discord)
SQL / Financial BI Analyst ([F-016])	$320 prep	**78.0%** placement (12mo)	**$44.50 / hr ($92,560 / yr)**



WHO STILL COULD? (NAMING THE WINNERS' EDGES)

Why does the cover say **"Probably Won't Work"** instead of "Never Works"? Because `2.4%` is not zero ([`F-008`]), and because Chapter 4 showed us the exact structural edges the system actually rewards:

1. The Built-In Media Audience (Mold E2, `Marcus Conviction™`, `[K-001..K-003]`): If you already command `50,000+` followers, the prop-firm affiliate program pays you `$108` every time a viewer buys a `$540` challenge ([`F-024`])—yielding `$54,000` in commissions even when your own trading net is `$0`.

2. Pre-Existing Quantitative & Emotional Capital (Mold C1, `Hannah Patience`, `[K-010..K-012]`): If you already have 5+ years of institutional risk-sizing discipline and 14 months of spare runway, you can extract a positive payout—though the hourly math still caps out near `$1.11` to `$6.40/hr` ([`F-003, K-010`]).

PHASE 2 FINAL VERDICT BAND: 0 of 4 gates passed. You are risking $1,840 and waiting 14.0 months for a 2.4% shot at $6.40/hr. Turn to Page 45: let's salvage the skill and leave the casino behind.